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WEDNESDAY

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026
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WAM

MOHAMMED TOURS NATURAL HISTORY MUSEUM ABU DHABI

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, visited the Natural History Museum Abu Dhabi, in the Saadiyat Cultural District. As part of the visit, Sheikh Mohammed was briefed on the Natural History Museum's immersive experience, which explores the history of the universe, Earth and life over millions of years.

US targets Iran's entire aviation sector in sanctions crackdown

Iran claims it seized advanced US underwater drone near Hormuz

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The United States imposed sanctions on "all remaining Iranian airlines" yesterday as Washington intensified its campaign to squeeze Tehran financially amid the months-long Middle East war.

The US Treasury Department said the measures targeted 36 entities supporting Iran's aviation sector, which it accused the government of using to transport weapons, personnel and illicit cargo.

They include 27 Iranian airlines, as well as companies based in countries including Turkey, Malaysia and Kazakhstan.

"Essentially, we're taking the entire aviation sector of the Iranian economy out of the market," a US Treasury official told reporters on condition of anonymity.

Severe consequences

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, who has declared an "economic D-Day" against Iran, warned of severe consequences for companies continuing to provide Tehran with financial lifelines. He said anyone doing business with Iran's remaining airlines risked being cut off from the global financial system.

The sanctions also target third-country companies accused of facilitating operations by Mahan Air, including cargo service providers and sales agents handling its international flights.

Washington has accused Mahan Air of facilitating activities linked to Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC).

Separately, the IRGC claimed yesterday that it had seized an advanced US unmanned submarine at the entrance to the Strait of Hormuz.

The Guards said the underwater drone was captured in an intelligence and operational mission at dawn and described it as one of the US military's most advanced unmanned underwater vehicles.

Iran said it would release images of the captured craft.

Iranian media said the drone was designed for underwater reconnaissance and surveillance, seabed mapping, mine detection and inspection of submarine cables and pipelines.

There was no immediate US confirmation of Iran's claim.

Separately, Iran's acting defence minister, Brig. Gen. Majid Ibn Reza, said that Iranian forces possess the ability to attack US warships enforcing what Tehran calls an "economic blockade".

AI may not replace you if you learn to use it right

Both AI fluency and human skills matter

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Employees worried about AI replacing parts of their jobs may need to pay closer attention to how they use the technology, with experts warning that handing over too much of the thinking can weaken the very skills that keep people valuable at work.

Three technology and workplace executives told *Gulf News* that employees who use AI to strengthen skills they already have, question its answers and spend the time saved on higher-value work could be better positioned as jobs change.

Summarising lengthy documents, organising data, producing an initial draft, conducting routine research, processing repetitive information and surfacing patterns are among the tasks the executives believe can increasingly be supported by AI.

The equation changes when trust, empathy, ethics or accountability enter the picture. Client relationships, negotiations, employee decisions, organisational culture, business strategy and difficult conversations still require people to understand the circumstances and take responsibility for the consequences.

READ THE FULL STORY
ON GULFNEWS.COM

UAE, GCC slam Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia

ENERGY FACILITIES HIT AS FIGHTING SURGES INSIDE YEMEN

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE and Gulf Cooperation Council strongly condemned Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia yesterday that wounded dozens of people and hit civilian and economic facilities, as Riyadh warned it would not hesitate to defend itself.

Saudi authorities said at least 73 people were injured, including women and children, in attacks on Abha, Khamis Mushait, Jazan and Najran.

Saudi Arabia's Energy Ministry said several energy facilities and installations in the south were targeted, triggering fires and forcing a temporary halt to some operations.

The UAE condemned the attacks in the strongest terms and also denounced the continued targeting of commercial vessels in the Red Sea, warning of the threat to maritime navigation.

GCC Secretary-General Jassem Al Budaiwi said the attacks deliberately targeted civilians, national assets and civilian in-

Oil prices climbed towards \$100 a barrel yesterday as the targeting of Saudi energy infrastructure compounded concerns over supplies already disrupted by the conflict around the Strait of Hormuz.

He called for a firm international response and reaffirmed the GCC's full solidarity with Saudi Arabia and support for measures taken to protect its territory, citizens and residents.

Over 500 killed in Yemen

The attacks on Saudi Arabia came amid a dramatic escalation of fighting inside Yemen.

More than 500 people have been killed since the Houthis launched an offensive last week to advance towards the Red Sea.

At least 216 government troops and 278 Houthi fighters have been killed, along with at least 29 civilians.

The fighting has centred on

the Houthi push towards areas near Bab Al Mandab, the strategic gateway connecting the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden. Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces have launched counteroffensives on several fronts.

Riyadh to defend itself

Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal Bin Farhan said the kingdom remained open to diplomacy but would protect itself and its interests. "The Kingdom will always support peace and diplomatic solutions," he said.

However, Saudi Arabia "will not hesitate to defend itself, protect its interests" and support measures to secure Yemen's stability, he added.

The Saudi-led coalition also vowed to take all necessary measures to respond to the sources of the threat and neutralise the danger.

The attacks have added another layer of pressure to global energy markets. Bab Al Mandab has become increasingly important for Saudi oil exports as restrictions in the Strait of Hormuz squeeze the kingdom's traditional Gulf shipping route.

— With inputs from AFP

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